

Left (top to bottom) A *chocolatería* stall serving hot chocolate at the carnival of Las Fallas in Valencia, Spain; coffee and doughnuts provide on-the-go urban fuel on Times Square, New York

Below (top to bottom) Sugar-coated ring doughnuts; a mariachi band performing near Churrería El Moro in Mexico City; *churros* dipped in chocolate in Oaxaca, Mexico



Morro Castle inexpensive
2500 Northwest Seventh Street, Miami, Florida;
(305) 642 4747

This classic 1950s drive-in is known for its Cuban sandwiches and *fritas* (burgers) made with a mixture of ground beef and chorizo sausage. But many locals also believe that Morro Castle serves the best traditional Spanish-style *churros* and hot chocolate in Miami.

Spudnut Shop inexpensive
228 Williams Boulevard, Richland, Washington;
www.richland.tri-cityshopping.com/spudnuts

A family-run bakery in the same location for more than 60 years, Spudnut uses a combination of potato flour and wheat flour to produce unusually airy yeast-raised and cake doughnuts. The family also bakes a line of spudnut muffins and cakes.

Café du Monde moderate
1039 Decatur Street, New Orleans, Louisiana;
www.cafedumonde.com

A stalwart of the city's French Quarter, this marketplace café creates legendary *beignets*—high and puffy squares of fried dough covered in powdered sugar. They are served in orders of three to accompany coffee given a nutty, slightly acrid taste by roasted chicory.

Maria's New Mexican Kitchen moderate
555 West Cordova Road, Santa Fe, New Mexico;
www.marias-santafe.com

This restaurant is justly famed for its authentic northern New Mexican cooking, based on fresh and dried chili peppers. The perfect conclusion to the hot and spicy courses comes in the form of soothing, honey-drizzled *sopapillas*—small, hollow, triangular “pillows” of sweet, fried dough.

Sra. Martinez moderate
4000 Northeast Second Avenue, Miami, Florida;
www.sramartinez.com

Diners at this stylish bistro in a former post office in the Design District understand that *churros* are no longer just street food. For dessert, chef Michelle Bernstein serves *churros* with a chocolate dipping sauce that she spikes with cayenne pepper.

MEXICO

It is said that when the Spanish explorer Hernán Cortés arrived in Mexico in 1519, the Aztecs mistook him for an incarnation of their god Quetzalcoatl, and served him up a feast including *xocoatl*, a cocoa-bean drink. The

Spanish kept the popular drink's ingredients a secret for 100 years, and eventually returned the favor by introducing Mexicans to the pleasures of *churros* dipped in thickened hot chocolate.

Café San Agustín inexpensive
Calle San Francisco 21, San Miguel de Allende;
+52 5154 9102

Both *churros* and chocolate at this popular café come in three degrees of sweetness: Spanish, French, and Mexican. The sweetest is Mexican, and it is spiced with the brassy, bright flavor of the papery Mexican *canela*, or cinnamon.

Churrería El Moro inexpensive
Calle Lázaro Cárdenas 42, Mexico City;
+52 5512 0896

Even the bespangled mariachi musicians from nearby Plaza Garibaldi patronize this 1935 landmark *churrería* for bags of *churros* doused with grainy sugar and the specialty hot chocolate, which is frothed with carved wooden *molinillos* (whisks) and served up in earthenware jugs.

ARGENTINA

Café culture is central to the Argentine capital, and *Porteños* (the inhabitants of Buenos Aires) often treat their favorite cafés as second living rooms—places to entertain friends and even conduct business over plates of *churros* and cups of hot chocolate.

La Giralda inexpensive
1453 Avenida Corrientes, Buenos Aires;
+54 11 4371 3846

This erstwhile hangout for Argentine intellectuals and theater-goers is the most famous of the cluster on Avenida Corrientes. It caters to the *Porteño* sweet tooth by filling its *churros* with chocolate cream or with *dulce de leche*, the city's signature milk caramel. Early risers and clubbers on the way home compete for morning tables.

Café Tortoni moderate
825 Avenida de Mayo, Buenos Aires;
www.cafetortoni.com.ar

Possibly the oldest café in Argentina, the historic and atmospheric Tortoni has been an integral part of *Porteño* life since 1858. A long-time favorite of politicians, intellectuals, and artists, its cigar-shaped, thick, and somewhat crunchy *churros* are best enjoyed with a *submarino*—a cup of hot milk served with a bar of dark chocolate (the “submarine”) which melts when dipped.